up and saw Peter in his room – the door ajar – and he was reading a passage from the Good Book. When he heard the lift door open, he looked up. There was nowhere for me to hide. There I am in my jeans and T-shirt when, obviously, I should have been in team kit, ready for the day's play. What could I do but walk past his room and hope he didn't see me? No such luck.

He looked up at me over his reading glasses, the Good Book in one hand, and said, 'Morning, Herschelle.'

'Morning, Pete,' I mumbled. I was – and there's only one word for it – fucked. I got to my room and woke Gogi up to tell him the whole story. I made him swear that he wouldn't tell anyone about my little adventure. By now I had also thought of a plan that could get me off the hook …

Our team physio, Craig Smith, could be my alibi. Craig was a great guy. He was a very good physio and also got on well with the guys. Craig was like one of the team and would cover for you just like your teammates would. I got hold of Craig and said, 'Listen, if anybody asks where I was, say I slept in your treatment room last night because my roommate had the shits and kept waking me up every half an hour. I decided the only way I could get some sleep was to kip down in your room.' When we sat down for breakfast, that was the story we told, but between Craig and me, it didn't quite add up. I could see none of the guys were really buying it.

I was feeling a little hung-over, though not *too* bad. We were fielding that day, and I was fine during the warm-up, taking all the catches that came my way. Unfortunately, once play got under way, I dropped two. Both were offered by Nathan Astle, and both were off Shaun Pollock's bowling. And it's not like they were screamers either. I was at cover, both balls came straight at me, and I put both down. Not good. Given that Peter had seen me sneak in that morning, I couldn't have chosen a worse bowler to drop catches off. And they were easy catches – on any other day I would have eaten them up.

Polly looked at captain Hansie Cronjé and said, 'Sheez. Was Herschy out last night?' At tea time Hansie came to me and said, 'Were you out last night?' I lied. 'No, man. Why?'

'Because PP said he saw you come in this morning past 7 a.m., still wearing your jeans and everything?' I was like, 'No, I just slept in Craig's room, you know, because I was …' But I couldn't lie any more. I told him the truth. So, at the end of the day's play, they called the team together in